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PORTFOLIO

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Nice to meet you. My name is Beatrice Mihiro Aquilani. I'm pursuing a *BA in Graphic Design & Media Arts*.

GRAPHIC DESIGN

SELECTED WORKS

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Here's a little package that gives you a sense of who I am and what I am learning and enjoy doing!

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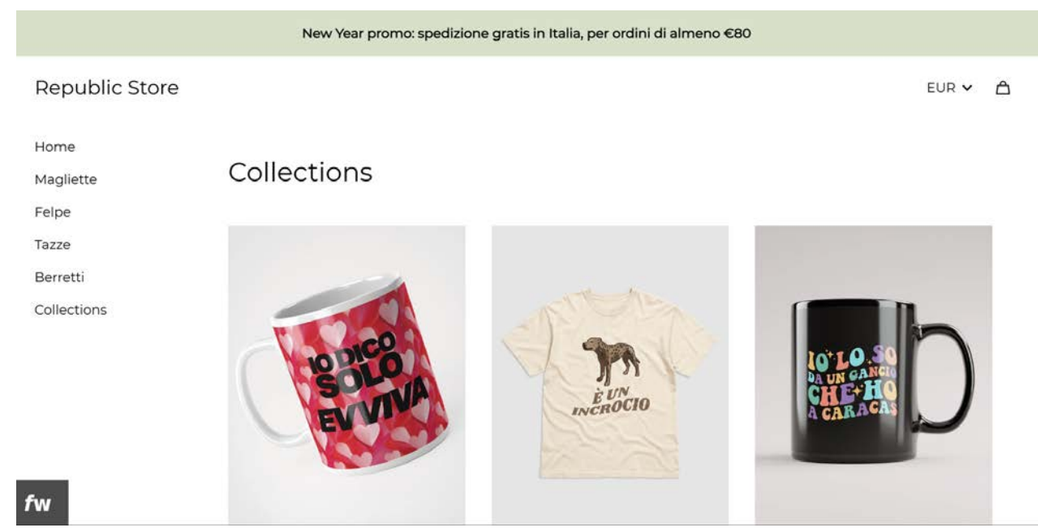
MERCH ILLUSTRATION

MERCH ILLUSTRATION FOR
I BELLISSIMI DI ZANZARA REPUBLIC

Youtube channel of *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic*
https://www.youtube.com/@BellissimiZanzaraRepublic

Client: *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic* - A popular Italian YouTube channel that offers a mix of humor, satire, and cultural commentary. The channel is known for its distinctive tone and niche audience appeal, making it a unique hub for fans seeking entertainment with a sharp and ironic edge.

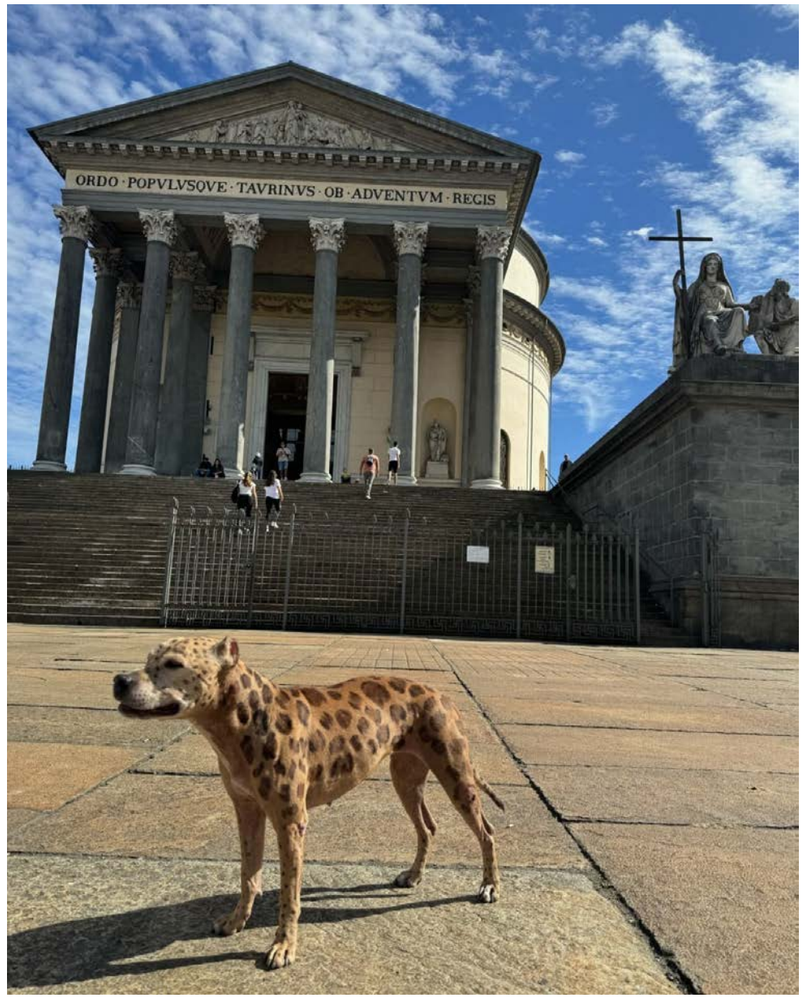
Project Description: I was commissioned to create an illustration for the YouTube channel's official merchandise shop, which is hosted on *Fourthwall*. The illustration was to be featured on a t-shirt and sweatshirt, and it became one of the shop's best-selling items.



The merch store on *Fourthwall*
https://i-bellissimi-di-zanzara-rep-shop.fourthwall.com/en-eur/

ABOUT THE SUBJECT: THE CANEPARDO

The design centers on the Canepardo, a viral internet phenomenon and cultural meme. The Canepardo is a hybrid creature—a mix of dog and leopard—whose existence sparks curiosity and humor. It gained attention through social media platforms like TikTok, where discussions about its authenticity and peculiar appearance became wildly popular. For this project, the client provided a reference image of the Canepardo and requested the inclusion of the phrase "*è un incrocio*" ("it's a hybrid"), encapsulating the satirical tone of the design.



Reference image I was given
https://www.instagram.com/p/DAiej2FIAN7/?img_index=2

THE CREATIVE PROCESS

The client's vision was clear: create a vibrant, humorous, and detailed vector illustration of the Canepardo that could resonate with the channel's audience. I started by analyzing the reference image provided, taking note of its unique features and how best to emphasize its hybrid nature. I also incorporated the client's chosen text, "*è un incrocio*," ensuring it complemented the overall visual style.

2. Illustration in Adobe Illustrator:

Using *Adobe Illustrator*, I crafted the vector illustration:

Line Work: I focused on clean, bold lines to capture the Canepardo's distinct features, such as its leopard spots and canine anatomy.

Color Palette: I selected a vivid yet balanced color scheme, carefully selected from the reference image, ensuring a close resemblance as well as enhancing the design's playful and striking appeal.

Typography Design: For "*è un incrocio*," I experimented with fonts and layouts to find the perfect style that matched the illustration's energy. I settled on a bold, slightly quirky typeface (Shrikhand), to which I then added a wave effect to maintain the humor and lightheartedness.

3. Integration into Merchandise:

I used the Fourthwall shop merch creator to bring the design to life on t-shirts and sweatshirts:

Placement and Scale: I ensured the illustration was scaled appropriately for maximum visibility and impact on the garments.

Base Colour: I chose ivory / sand as the base colour, to ensure a base light enough to enhance the illustration, but also that matched the illustration's colour palette, to ensure aesthetics.

Product Variants: The design was applied to t-shirts and sweatshirts, as well as hoodies. However the placement of the text has been changed, offering variety to fans of the channel.

RESULTS AND RECEPTION:

The final products were launched in the channel's merch store and quickly became a fan favorite. The humorous and vibrant design resonated with the audience, and the Canepardo-themed merchandise became one of the top-selling options.

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

Collaboration: Working with I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic allowed me to merge their unique brand voice with my creative expertise.

Design Versatility: Adobe Illustrator's flexibility was instrumental in achieving a high-quality, scalable design suitable for merchandise.

E-Commerce Integration: The Fourthwall shop merch creator provided an intuitive platform for translating digital artwork into tangible products.

This project exemplified the power of combining humor, internet culture, and sharp design to create merchandise that not only represents a brand but also deeply connects with its community.

Fōcus 05

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FOCUS 05 RESTAURANT REBRANDING PROJECT

FINAL PROJECT FOR THE UNIVERSITY COURSE

DESIGN THINKING FOR GRAPHIC DESIGNERS

PHASE ONE: EMPATHIZE AND IDEATE

Fictional Client: Focus 05 – A unique dining experience located in Manhattan's trendy SoHo district. The restaurant sought to rebrand and attract their target audience of Millennials (ages 22–42) through updated subway banner advertising that aligns with their values and preferences.

Role: Junior Graphic Designer

Objective: Create visually engaging subway advertisements to reposition the restaurant as a hub for Millennials by leveraging design thinking principles and a human-centered approach.

Human-Centered Design in Practice

Understanding the Millennial audience was critical for this project. As a generation, Millennials value experiences, authenticity, and vibrant visuals that reflect their lifestyle. My design process prioritized empathy by incorporating their needs, preferences, and behaviors. This foundation ensured the designs resonated deeply with the target audience.

Target Audience Analysis

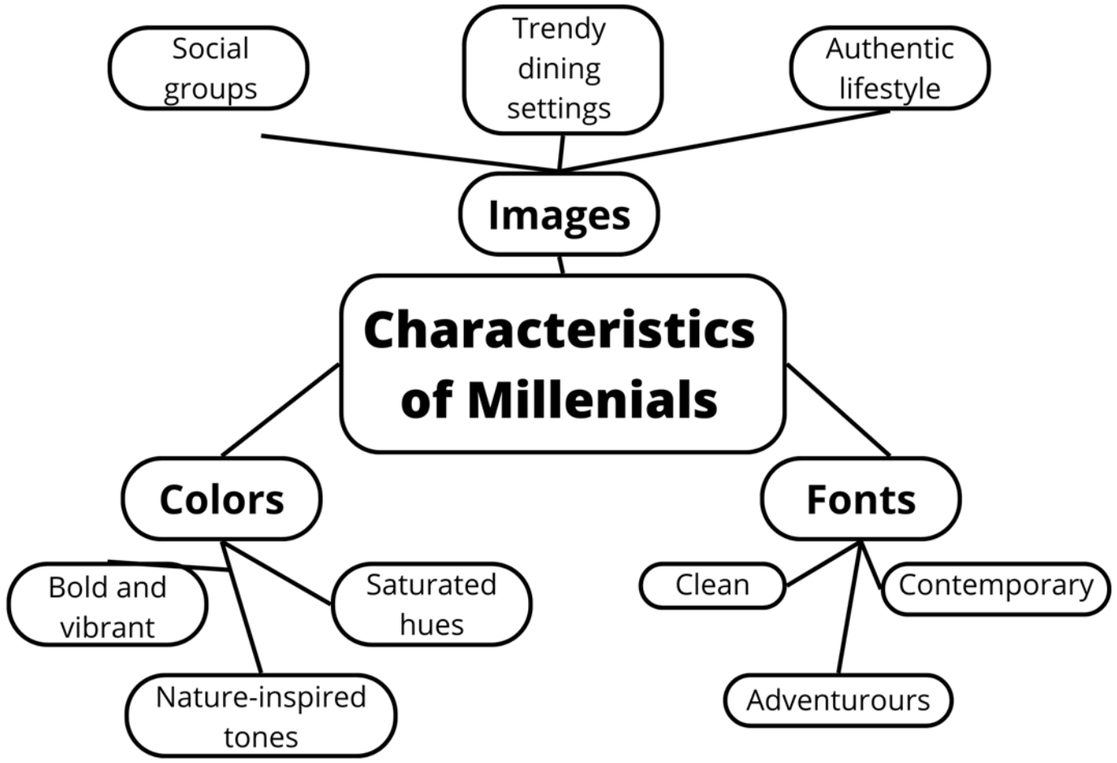
Millennials are tech-savvy, socially connected, and value sustainability and inclusivity. They prefer bold, image-heavy ads with minimal text and modern, sans serif fonts. My research highlighted their preference for vibrant color palettes and images that reflect group dining, social interaction, and adventurous experiences.

Creative Outputs: Mood Board

Featured vibrant color swatches (deep greens, mustard yellows, terracotta), clean sans serif fonts (Montserrat, Bebas Neue), and images representing social dining, fresh food, and urban aesthetics.

Creative Outputs: Mind Map

Centralized on Millennial characteristics with key branches focused on visuals (social connections, dining experiences), colors (vibrant and natural tones), and fonts (modern sans serif).



PHASE TWO: IDEATE, DEFINE, AND MOCK-UP

Problem Statement

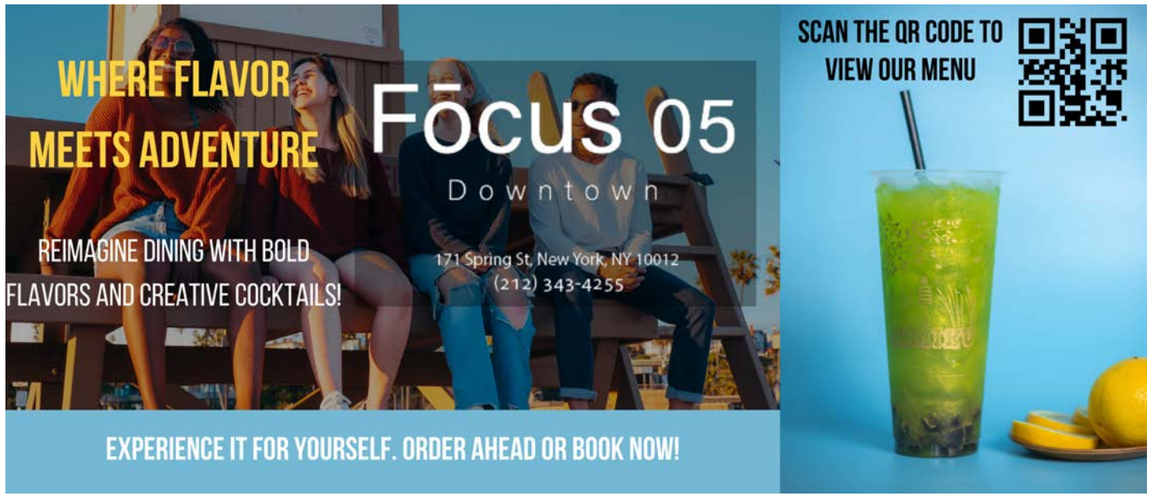
The current subway ad was misaligned with Millennial preferences, featuring text-heavy layouts, muted colors, and traditional fonts that resonated more with Baby Boomers. My goal was to redesign the advertisement to reflect the vibrant, social, and modern values of Millennials.

Design Solutions

Using Adobe Illustrator, I created three mock-ups, each addressing distinct aspects of Millennial preferences:

01 ***Social Dining Experience:*** Highlighted group interactions and vibrant imagery with a clean, sans serif typeface and a QR code for easy engagement.

02 ***Unique Dishes, Unique Moments:*** Focused on adventurous and Instagram-worthy visuals of unique dishes paired with modern typography and bold patterns.



03 ***Sustainable and Social:*** Emphasized sustainability with earthy color tones and fresh imagery, promoting values-driven dining experiences.

PHASE THREE: TEST AND ITERATE

Iterations

Based on my professor's feedback, I refined each mock-up to enhance their appeal and functionality:

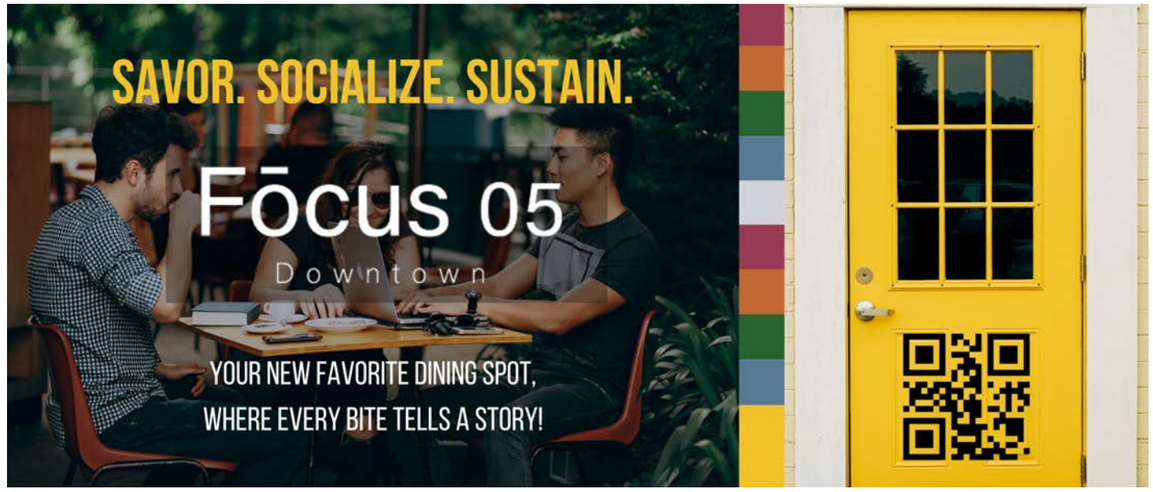
1. Simplified text to concise, impactful taglines.

2. Replaced small, unreadable details with prominently placed QR codes.

3. Improved spacing and margins for visual clarity.

4. Adjusted color palettes and layouts to better align with Millennial aesthetics.

01 ***Social Dining Experience***



02 ***Unique Dishes, Unique Moments***

03 ***Sustainable and Social***

Design Justifications

The iterations incorporated feedback to better represent Millennial values and preferences:

Typography: Clean, sans serif fonts ensured modernity and readability.

Color Palette: Vibrant hues paired with natural tones conveyed energy and sustainability.

Imagery: Group settings and adventurous dining moments highlighted social and experiential elements central to Millennials.

FINAL DELIVERABLES

The final subway advertisements successfully positioned Focus 05 as a trendy, inclusive dining destination tailored to Millennials. The use of human-centered design principles ensured the project not only met but exceeded client expectations, creating visually compelling and functional designs that resonated with the target audience.

This project underscored the importance of empathy, creative problem-solving, and iterative design in creating solutions that bridge the gap between branding and audience engagement.

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EXTENDED MERCH DESIGNS

EXTENDED MERCH DESIGNS FOR
I BELLISSIMI DI ZANZARA REPUBLIC

Following the success of the Canepardo-themed t-shirt and sweatshirt designs for the *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic* YouTube channel, I expanded the merchandise collection with additional products featuring new and complementary designs.

These additions further aligned with the humor, creativity, and branding of the channel, catering to its engaged fanbase.

CANEPARDO-THEMED MERCHANDISE

Mug Designs

Building on the Canepardo illustration and text ("*è un incrocio*") I previously created, I designed three distinct mug options for the *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic Fourthwall* shop.

These designs offer variety and versatility while maintaining the bold and humorous aesthetic that fans expect.

01

A sleek black base featuring the Canepardo illustration on one side and the text on the opposite side.

02

A clean white base with the same layout as Mug 1.

03

A playful design on a white base, where the "*è un incrocio*" text is positioned centrally, surrounded by multiple small Canepardo illustrations.

Baseball Hat Design

For fans looking for wearable merchandise, I created a Stone-colored baseball hat featuring:

- The Canepardo illustration embroidered on the front, providing a high-quality and durable representation of the design.
- The text "è un incrocio" embroidered on the left side for added personality and brand alignment.

The minimalist design and neutral color choice ensure broad appeal while keeping the focus on the playful and iconic Canepardo theme.

"IO DICO SOLO EVVIVA" DESIGN

To diversify the merchandise line, the YouTuber requested a dual-typography text illustration:

The phrase "*io dico solo*" was set in the Aktiv Grotesk font, with a clean and modern black typeface.

The word "*evviva*" was styled larger, italicized, and slanted, creating a sense of movement and excitement.

These text illustrations were used to create several merchandise items:

This phrase is a famous quote by Italian journalist Vittorio Feltri, known for his sharp and often humorous commentary. Its inclusion in the merchandise resonates with fans of I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic who appreciate satirical and iconic cultural references.

Mug Design

A black base mug where "*io dico solo*" is written on the front, and "*evviva*" is prominently displayed on the back in bold, italicized form.

T-shirt Design

A charcoal-colored t-shirt with the same typography, ensuring versatility for fans who prefer lightweight apparel.

Sweatshirt Designs

Four variations (black, navy, dark heather, and red) with:

- "*io dico solo*" subtly placed on the front, in the top left corner.
- "*evviva*" written large and slanted along the left sleeve, creating a bold and dynamic statement.

"È FATTUALE" DESIGN

For this request, I created a new text illustration featuring "*è fattuale*."

This phrase is a notable quote by Italian journalist and radio host David Parenzo. It embodies his energetic and positive style, making it a perfect fit for the lively and humorous branding of the merchandise. Fans of the channel will immediately recognize and connect with this playful nod to his signature expression.

Using the Keep On Truckin font, I applied a wave effect in Adobe Illustrator to create a dynamic and retro-inspired look.

The design was applied to a black-base mug, keeping the focus on the bold typography while ensuring it fits seamlessly within the shop's merchandise aesthetic.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

This expanded collection demonstrates a seamless integration of humor, typography, and branding, further cementing the unique identity of *I Bellissimi di Zanzara Republic*. Each piece was designed with the fanbase in mind, offering variety and style while staying true to the channel's playful and creative spirit.

These designs not only celebrate the channel's humor but also reflect its strong connection with the audience, ensuring the merchandise resonates with their tastes and expectations.

COLLEGE PIZZA ADVERT REDESIGN

PROJECT FOR THE UNIVERSITY COURSE
DESIGN THINKING FOR GRAPHIC DESIGNERS

UNDERSTANDING THE TARGET AUDIENCE

Fictional Client: College Pizza – A budget-friendly pizza outlet located near a college campus, aiming to appeal to students aged 18–24 by promoting affordability, convenience, and classic pizza appeal.

Objective: Redesign the restaurant's advertisement to resonate with the target audience, emphasizing budget-friendly pricing and quick service, while maintaining a casual and approachable visual style.

Key Insights

Demographics: College students aged 18–24, living near campus, prioritize saving money and time.

Preferences: They value bright, bold colors (red, yellow, black) and casual sans serif fonts, associating these elements with affordability and simplicity.

Expectations: Graphics and layouts should be busy yet cohesive, emphasizing value and quick service with traditional pizza imagery rather than high-end visuals.

DESIGN PROCESS AND MOCK-UP

1. Assessing Design Needs

Headline & Text: The headline "Grab a Slice for Less!" is bold and inviting, conveying affordability. The sub-headline "Budget-Friendly Combos for Hungry Students!" directly appeals to their desire for low-cost options. Additional text like "Quick, Delicious, Affordable" reinforces key values of speed, taste, and budget.

Images: A close-up shot of pepperoni pizza highlights the product's appeal, avoiding overly stylized imagery that could suggest high prices.

Logo: The "College Pizza" logo is positioned prominently in the top right corner for brand recognition while ensuring the main text and imagery remain the focal points.

Color Palette: Bold red, yellow, and black colors create high contrast and reinforce affordability while maintaining visual energy.

2. Mock-Up Design

The poster uses a busy layout to maximize value perception, with minimal negative space to avoid conveying an expensive feel.

Fonts are sans serif for clarity and approachability, ensuring the text is readable at a glance.

Imagery of pepperoni pizza is central to the design, paired with high-contrast colors to immediately draw attention and appeal to the target audience.

3. Rationale

Color Choices: Red and yellow are associated with affordability and speed, ideal for a budget-conscious college crowd. Black adds contrast for readability and a bold aesthetic.

Font Choices: Bold sans serif fonts are used to reflect the casual and approachable nature of the brand while maintaining clarity.

Layout Choices: A busy and packed layout aligns with the perception of value, making the ad appear budget-friendly and engaging.

Imagery: Close-up pizza visuals create appetite appeal while staying relatable and within budget-oriented aesthetics.

Logo Placement: The logo in the top-right corner reinforces brand recognition without overshadowing the headline or image.

FINAL PRODUCT

Image Reference: Horizon Content. "Photo Of Person Holding Sliced Pizza." *Pexels*, 11 Mar. 2020, https://www.pexels.com/photo/photo-of-person-holding-sliced-pizza-3915857/

The redesigned advertisement successfully communicates College Pizza's value proposition to its target audience. The bold headline, vibrant colors, and appetizing imagery ensure the ad grabs attention and conveys affordability, making it highly appealing to college students. By aligning the design with their preferences and lifestyle, this advertisement positions College Pizza as a go-to option for budget-conscious, hungry students.

This project highlights the importance of combining audience insights with thoughtful design choices to create effective and engaging marketing materials tailored to specific demographics.

Thank you for your time!

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